

IT Research Methodology

Plagiarism

Image Source: Research Methodology

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UNDERSTANDING AND AVOIDING PLAGIARISM

UNDERSTANDING WHAT PLAGIARISM IS

- Using the **words** or **ideas** of another person without giving credit (on purpose or unintentionally)
- This may include (but is not limited to):
  - Copying an entire piece from another author, a website, etc.
  - Copying parts of someone else's writing, speech, etc. without giving proper credit
  - Paraphrasing (rewording) passages or information without giving credit to the author or source using an appropriate citation style
  - Having someone make changes to your paper
  - Having someone dictate sentences for you
  - Buying or borrowing someone's paper and turning it in as your own
  - ***In some schools, turning in the same paper for two different classes is considered plagiarism as well

WHY PLAGIARISM IS CONSIDERED UNACCEPTABLE

- In the U.S.:
  - Originality is important
  - Respect for others' work is important
    - This means we always make it clear when we borrow words or ideas from someone else
- The goal of research is to learn something new about a topic of interest and to add your ideas and your voice to the ongoing discussion.

WHAT HAPPENS IF STUDENTS PLAGIARIZE

- Plagiarism can have serious results, including:
  - A failing grade on the assignment
  - Disciplinary report sent to the Student Life Office (which deans and other professors can see) and/or note in a student's academic records
  - Suspension or expulsion from college

Note: Other schools may have different policies.

HOW STUDENTS CAN AVOID PLAGIARISM

1. While receiving tutoring/help from others:

Students are encouraged:

- To ask questions and listen to suggestions and write their own ideas and use their own words
- To not procrastinate; leaving papers to the last minute leads to a higher chance of copying and forgetting to cite.

2. While researching:

Students are encouraged:

- To annotate articles using their own words
- To create note cards or a notes-sheet in which they specify:
  - Whether it is a direct quote or paraphrase
  - Full citation
  - Page number(s)—if applicable

3. While writing a research or academic paper:

Students are encouraged:

- To check that ALL sources are cited in their paper
  - Include author's name and information about the source (where they found the information)

HOW TO CITE AND INTEGRATE A SOURCE THE FIRST TIME (MLA FORMAT)

Information to include in citations:

- **1) the author's idea or words (quote, paraphrase, or summary)**
- 2) the name of the author or organization
- *3) brief explanation of who that person is*
- 4) where the information can be found (e.g., newspaper, book, etc.)

Cite all four the first time a source is referenced in a paper!

Example:

"California has become the first state to implement a law that addresses working conditions for warehouse workers, like those for Amazon and other major companies," states *journalist* Jaclyn Diaz in the NPR online article, "A New Law In California Aims To Protect Workers At Retail Warehouses Like Amazon's."

HOW TO PROPERLY CITE SOURCES AFTER THE FIRST CITATION

- When that author and work is quoted after that, the author's last name and just the citation is used.

Example:
Diaz explains the positive and negative effects of this new law in the news article.

WHERE TO USE CITATIONS IN AN ESSAY

- Citations appear in two places:
  - in the text ("in-text citations")
  - in the works-cited or bibliography page at the end of your paper

- Citations are **unnecessary** when the information is ***common knowledge***.*

**More on this later.*

WHERE TO USE CITATIONS IN AN ESSAY(*CONTINUED*)

Include the full citation in the MLA Works Cited page:

Works Cited

Diaz, Jaclyn. "A New Law In California Aims To Protect Workers At Retail Warehouses Like Amazon's." *NPR*, 23 Sept. 2021, https://www.npr.org/2021/09/23/1039970039/californias-new-law-targets-amazon-warehouses

In-text citation:

"California has become the first state to implement a law that addresses working conditions for warehouse workers, like those for Amazon and other major companies," states journalist **Jaclyn Diaz in the NPR online article, "A New Law In California Aims To Protect Workers At Retail Warehouses Like Amazon's."**

WHERE TO USE CITATIONS IN AN ESSAY(*CONTINUED I*)

Include the full citation in the APA Reference List page:

Reference

Diaz, J. (2021, 23 September). *A new law in California aims to protect workers at retail warehouses like Amazon's.* NPR. https://www.npr.org/2021/09/23/1039970039/californias-new-law-targets-amazon-warehouses

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WHERE TO USE CITATIONS IN AN ESSAY(*CONTINUED 2*)

Include the full citation in the Chicago Style Reference List page:

Bibliography

Diaz, Jaclyn. "A New Law In California Aims To Protect Workers At Retail Warehouses Like Amazon's." *NPR*, (23 September 2021), https://www.npr.org/2021/09/23/1039970039/californias-new-law-targets-amazon-warehouses

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WAYS TO CITE IN-TEXT

- **Example 1:** In the U.S., before the average child is twelve, he will have witnessed over 8,000 murders on television (Sullivan 677).
- **Example 2:** According to Jones (1998), "students often had difficulty using APA style, especially when it was their first time" (p. 199).
- **Example 3:** In the article "Kip Kinkel: A Boy's Life," *Rolling Stone* reporter Randall Sullivan notes that after the Springfield school shootings "the newspapers trotted out the now-familiar numbers: the 8,000 on-screen murders that the average American child will witness before finishing elementary school." [1]

1. Can you identify the four elements of proper citations in these examples?
(refer to slide 6 for review)

2. Which citation style is presented? MLA, APA, or Chicago Style?

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1. Randall Sullivan, "Kip Kinkel: A Boy's Life," *Rolling Stone* , (1998, October 1), https://www.rollingstone.com/culture/culture-news/kip-kinkel-a-boys-life-part-2-69473/

WAYS TO CITE IN-TEXT (CONTINUED)

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WAYS TO CITE IN-TEXT (MLA FORMAT) ANSWERS

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1) MLA FORMAT
2) APA FORMAT
3) CHICAGO STYLE FORMAT

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PRACTICE: IDENTIFYING PLAGIARISM

1) Which of the following is plagiarism?

a. Looking at a friend's essay to get an idea of how to write your essay
b. Having a friend help you organize your essay
c. Having a friend correct your errors in an essay

2) Which of the following is <u>not</u> plagiarism?

a. Cutting and pasting from an online source
b. Using parts of someone's essay
c. Copying words and phrases from a reading
d. Using ideas from an article that you have paraphrased and cited

3) Which of the following is <u>not</u> plagiarism?

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COMMON KNOWLEDGE

- **What is common knowledge?**
  - Information that many people know and that you can find in many sources
  - Information that is so basic and factual that most, if not all, sources would agree with it
  - It often includes widely known information about:
    - current events
    - geographical facts
    - familiar history

Examples →

EXAMPLES OF COMMON KNOWLEDGE

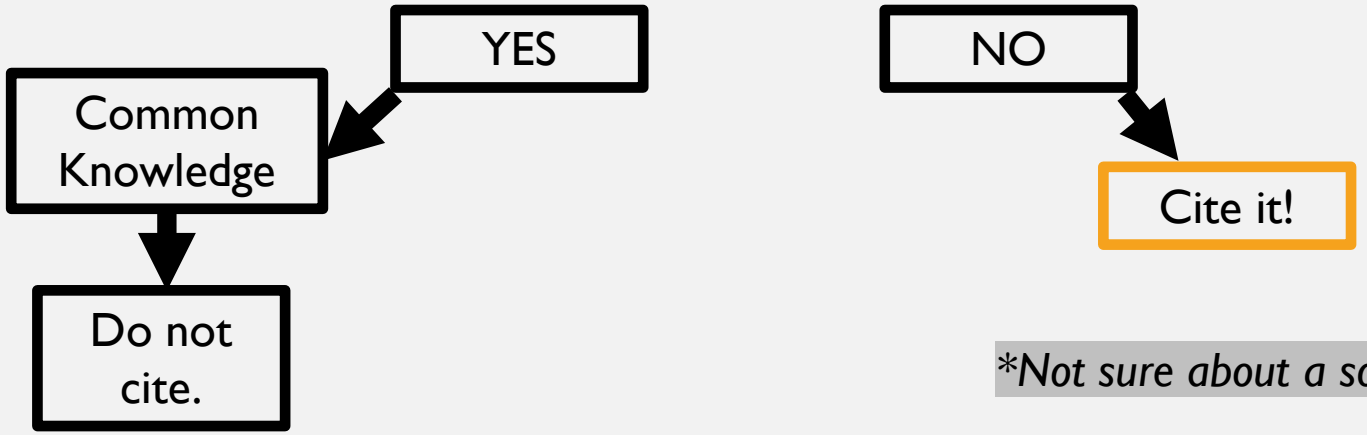
- Some examples of common/general knowledge:
  - Walt Disney created Disneyland.
  - George Washington was the first president of the United States.
  - *Titanic* was the movie that made Kate Winslet famous.
  - Stomach pain can be a side effect of aspirin use.
  - The sun rises in the east.
- Each of the above statements would be considered generally true or accepted in its field, and we can find these same facts in multiple sources. Statements like the above would not need to be cited.
- Also, feel free to use familiar proverbs ("You can't judge a book by its cover") without citing.

COMMON KNOWLEDGE VERSUS MATERIAL THAT NEEDS TO BE CITED

- **What is <u>NOT</u> common knowledge and, therefore, needs to be cited?**
  - Other people's opinions, analysis, interpretations, specific wording or data
  - Information that is disputable
    For example:
    - George Washington was the most trustworthy president of the United States.
    - Procrastination can have serious effects.
    - 13% of Americans thought that *Titanic* was a terrible movie.
    - People should avoid taking aspirin because it can harm the stomach lining.
  - If you got the above ideas from a source, you would need to cite them.

COMMON KNOWLEDGE VERSUS MATERIAL THAT NEEDS TO BE CITED (*CONTINUED*)

- **Common Knowledge Test**
  - To determine if the information you want to use is common knowledge or not, ask yourself the following three questions:
    1. Can I find this information in many different sources?
    2. Do many people know this information?
    3. Did I know this information before I began researching?



**Not sure about a source? It is better to overcite than to not cite.*